

Tiny Bodies, Big Brains — Module 02: Agents — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. Why do babies stare at you? (They are studying your face — gathering data!).
2. What makes YOU a "Little Scientist"? (You ask questions, test ideas, and learn from results).
3. What is a "Hypothesis"? (A fancy word for a guess you can test).
4. When you see yourself in a mirror, how do you know it is you? (Self-awareness!).
5. Do you think a baby knows they are a separate person from their parent?
6. Why do kids copy what grown-ups do? (Imitation is the fastest way to learn a new skill).
7. What experiment would you run if you could test anything? (No idea is too silly!).
8. How are you different from a robot? (You have feelings, creativity, and free will).
9. What question do you ask the most? ("Why?" is a scientist's best tool!).
10. If you could study any animal, which one would you choose and why?

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Do the "Mirror Test" at home: Put a small sticker on your forehead. Look in a mirror. Do you reach for the sticker on your face or on the mirror? You know that is YOU!
2. Try an experiment: Drop different objects (feather, ball, spoon) from the same height. Predict which will hit the ground first. Were you right? That is the scientific method!
3. Watch a baby or toddler for five minutes (a sibling, a video, or at a park). Write down everything they do. How many experiments are they running? (Dropping things? Tasting things? Testing reactions?).
4. Play "Copy Cat": One person does a movement. Everyone copies it exactly. Then the leader adds a step. Keep going. How is imitation a form of learning?
5. Draw a "Self-Portrait" showing everything that makes you unique. Include things you love, things you are good at, and things you want to learn.

6. Record yourself saying something, then play it back. Does your voice sound like you expected? Your model of yourself just got updated!
7. Ask a family member to describe you in three words. Do their words match how you would describe yourself? Our model of ourselves and others' models of us can be different!
8. Make a "Curiosity Jar": Write questions on slips of paper and put them in a jar. Pull one out each day and try to find the answer together.
9. Try to teach a pet a trick (or imagine teaching one). What steps does the "agent" (the pet) need to take? What motivates them?
10. Before bed, write down the most interesting thing you observed today. Scientists always keep notes. You are building your own data about the world!